
DEVELOPING YOUR
VOCABULARY THROUGH
PREFIXES, ROOTS, AND
SUFFIXES THAT CAN GIVE
YOU THE MEANING OF
OVER 200,000 WORDS

A Gruber Prefix-Root-Suffix List that Gives You the Meaning of Over 200,000 Words

According to some linguistic studies made, approximately 60 percent of our English words are derived from Latin and Greek. The following Latin and Greek roots, prefixes, and suffixes frequently show up in some of the words that appear in Reading Skills passages. Learn these Latin and Greek word parts to increase your reading vocabulary immensely and thus score well in your Reading Skills test. These prefixes, roots, and suffixes can give you the meaning of over 200,000 words!

Latin and Greek Roots

The shortest and best way of learning a language is to know the roots of it; that is, those original primitive words of which other words are formed.

—Lord Chesterfield

Roots are parts of words that come from other languages—chiefly Latin and Greek. These roots are used as important “building blocks” of many of our English words. As you study the following list of Latin and Greek roots, have a dictionary by your side. Look up the meanings of the word examples that are given with the roots, if you do not know what the word examples mean.

<u>ROOT</u>	<u>MEANING AND EXAMPLE</u>
ag, act	do, drive, act; as <i>agent</i> , <i>counteract</i> .
alt	high; as <i>altitude</i> , <i>altar</i> .
anim	mind; as <i>unanimous</i> , <i>animosity</i>
ann	year; as <i>annals</i> , <i>biennial</i> .
aper, apert	open; as <i>aperient</i> , <i>aperture</i> .
apt	fit, join; as <i>adapt</i> .
arch	rule, govern; as <i>anarchy</i> .
art	skill; as <i>art</i> .
aud	hear, listen; as <i>audible</i> .
aur	gold; as <i>auriferous</i> (ferr = carry).
bas	low; as <i>debase</i> .

<u>ROOT</u>	<u>MEANING AND EXAMPLE</u>
bat	beat; as <i>battle</i> .
bit	bite; as <i>bite</i> , <i>bitter</i> .
brev	short; as <i>abbreviate</i> .
cad, cas	fall; as <i>cadence</i> , <i>casual</i> , <i>accident</i> .
cant	sing; as <i>canticle</i> , <i>chant</i> .
cap, capt	take, hold; as <i>capable</i> , <i>captive</i> .
capit	head; as <i>capital</i> .
carn	flesh; as <i>carnivorous</i> (vor = devour).
ced, cess	go, yield; as <i>accede</i> , <i>access</i> .
celer	swift; as <i>celerity</i> .
cent	hundred; as <i>century</i> .
cing, cinet	bind; as <i>surcingle</i> , <i>cincture</i> , <i>succinct</i> .
clin	lean, bend; as <i>decline</i> .
commod	suitable; as <i>commodious</i> .
commun	common; as <i>community</i> .
cor, cord	heart; as <i>accord</i> .
coron	crown; as <i>coronation</i> .
corpus, corpor	body; as <i>corpuscle</i> ; <i>corporal</i> .
cred	believe; as <i>credible</i> .
cur	care; as <i>accurate</i> .
curr, curs	run; as <i>current</i> , <i>cursory</i> .
cycl	circle; as <i>bicycle</i> .
dat	give; as <i>date</i> , <i>edition</i> .
dent	tooth; as <i>dentist</i> .
di	day; as <i>dial</i> .
dict	speak, say; as <i>contradict</i> .
dign	worthy; as <i>dignity</i> , <i>disdain</i> .
domin	lord, master; as <i>dominate</i> .
dorm	sleep; as <i>dormant</i> .
due, duct	lead, bring; as <i>induce</i> , <i>conduct</i> .

ROOT

MEANING AND EXAMPLE

equ	equal; as <i>equanimity</i> (anim = mind).
fa	speak; as <i>affable</i> .
fac	face, form; as <i>efface</i> .
fac, fact	make, form, do; as <i>facile, faction</i> .
felic	happy; as <i>felicity</i> .
fer	carry, bear, bring; as <i>fertile, confer</i> .
fess	acknowledge; as <i>confess</i> .
fid	faith, trust; as <i>confide</i> .
fin	end, limit; as <i>final</i> .
form	shape; as <i>conform</i> .
fort	strong; as <i>fortitude</i> .
frag, fract	break; as <i>fragile, fraction</i> .
fund, fus	pour, melt; as <i>fusible, confound</i> .
gen, gener	kind, race; as <i>gender, general</i> .
gest	carry; bring; as <i>congestion</i> .
grad; gress	step, go; as <i>gradual, digress</i> .
gran	grain; as <i>granary</i> .
graph	write; as <i>autograph</i> .
grat	pleasing; as <i>grateful</i> .
gross	fat, thick; as <i>gross</i> .
hor	hour; as <i>horology</i> .
hospit	host, guest; as <i>hospitable</i> .
integr	entire, whole; as <i>integral</i> .
ject	throw; as <i>inject</i> .
judic	judge; as <i>judiciary</i> .
junct	join; as <i>conjunction</i> .
jur	swear; as <i>adjure</i> .
jur	law, right; as <i>jurist</i> .
lat	carry, bring; as <i>dilate</i> .
leg	send, bring; as <i>legacy, allege</i> .

<u>ROOT</u>	<u>MEANING AND EXAMPLE</u>
leg, lect	gather, choose; as <i>legion</i> , <i>eclectic</i> .
liber	free; as <i>liberty</i> .
lin	flax; as <i>linen</i> , <i>lining</i> .
lingu	tongue; as <i>linguist</i> .
liter	letter; as <i>literal</i> ; <i>literary</i> .
loc	place; as <i>local</i> ; <i>dislocate</i> .
log	word, speech, reason; as <i>catalogue</i> , <i>logic</i> .
loqu, locut	speak, talk; as <i>loquacious</i> , <i>circumlocution</i> .
lud, lus	sport, play; as <i>ludicrous</i> , <i>illusion</i> .
magn	great; as <i>magnitude</i> .
major	greater; as <i>majority</i> .
man	hand; as <i>manual</i> , <i>maintain</i> .
man, mans	stay, dwell; as <i>manor</i> , <i>mansion</i> .
mar	the sea; as <i>marine</i> .
mater, matr	mother; as <i>maternal</i> , <i>matrimony</i> .
medi	middle, between; as <i>mediate</i> .
medic	physician; as <i>medicine</i> .
mens	measure; as <i>mensuration</i> .
ment	mind; as <i>mental</i> .
merc	merchandise, trade; as <i>commerce</i> .
merg	dip, sink; as <i>submerge</i> .
meter; metr	measure; as <i>chronometer</i> , <i>symmetry</i> .
migr	wander; as <i>migrate</i> .
mir	wonder, look; as <i>admire</i> , <i>mirror</i> .
mit, miss	send; as <i>admit</i> , <i>commission</i> .
mon, monit	advise, remind; as <i>monument</i> , <i>monitor</i> .
mort	death; as <i>mortal</i> .
mot	move; as <i>motor</i> .
mult	many; as <i>multitude</i> .
mun, munit	fortify; as <i>munition</i> .

ROOT

nat

nav

not

numer

nunci, nounce

ocul

pan

par

par

parl

pars, part

pass

past

pat, pass

pater, patr

ped

pell, puls

pen

pend, pens

pet, petit

petr

phil, philo

phon

physi

pict

plac

ple, plet

plen

plic

plum

MEANING AND EXAMPLE

born; as *natal*.

ship; as *naval*.

known; as *notice*.

number; as *numerous*.

tell; as *enunciate*, *announce*.

eye; as *oculist*.

bread; as *pantry*.

equal; as *disparity*.

get ready; as *compare*.

speak; as *parley*.

part; as *parse*, *apart*.

step; as *compass*.

feed; as *pasture*.

suffer, feel; as *patient*, *passive*.

father; as *paternal*, *patrician*.

foot; as *biped*.

drive; as *compel*, *expulsion*.

pain, punishment; as *penal*.

hang, weigh, pay; as *pendant*, *pension*.

seek; as *impetus*, *petition*.

stone, rock; as *petrify*.

loving; as *philosophy* (soph = wisdom).

sound; as *phonic*.

nature; as *physiology* (log = word, reason).

paint; as *picture*.

please; as *placable*.

fill; as *complement*, *complete*.

full; as *plenty*.

fold, bend; as *complicate*.

feather; as *plumage*.

<u>ROOT</u>	<u>MEANING AND EXAMPLE</u>
plumb	lead; as <i>plumber</i> .
pon	to place, put; as <i>component</i> .
port	carry, bring; <i>porter</i> .
port	gate; as <i>portal</i> .
pos	to place, put; as <i>compose</i> .
pot	drink; as <i>potion</i> .
potent	powerful; as <i>potentate</i> .
prehend, prehens	take, grasp; as <i>apprehend</i> , <i>prehensile</i> .
prim	first; as <i>primary</i> .
punct	prick, point; as <i>puncture</i> .
quadr	square, fourfold; as <i>quadrant</i> .
quant	how much; as <i>quantity</i> .
quer, quisit	seek, ask; as <i>query</i> , <i>inquisition</i> .
quies	rest; as <i>acquiescent</i> .
radi	ray; as <i>radiant</i> .
rap, rapt	seize, grasp; as <i>rapacious</i> , <i>rapture</i> .
rat	think, calculate; as <i>ratio</i> .
rect	ruled, straight, right; as <i>rectangle</i> .
reg	rule, govern; as <i>regent</i> .
rid, ris	laugh; as <i>ridiculous</i> , <i>risible</i> .
riv	stream; as <i>river</i> , <i>derive</i> .
rog, rogat	ask; as <i>interrogate</i> .
rupt	break; as <i>rupture</i> .
saer	holy; as <i>sacred</i> .
sal	salt; as <i>saline</i> .
sal	leap; as <i>salient</i> .
sanct	holy; as <i>sanction</i> .
sat, satis	enough; as <i>sate</i> , <i>satisfy</i> .
sci	know; as <i>science</i> .
scop	watch, view; as <i>horoscope</i> .

ROOT

scrib, script

sec, sect

sen

sent, sens

sequ, secut

serv

sist

sol

son

sort

spec, spect

speci

spir

stat

stell

string, strict

stru, struct

su

suad, suas

sum, sumpt

surg, surrect

tact

tail

tang

teg, tect

tempor

tend, tent

test

tort

tract

MEANING AND EXAMPLE

write; as *describe*, *subscription*.

cut; as *secant*, *bisect*.

old; as *senior*.

feel, think; as *sentiment*, *sensible*.

follow; as *sequel*, *consecutive*.

keep; as *conserve*.

to place, stand; as *assist*.

alone; as *solitude*.

sound; as *consonant*.

lot, kind; as *assort*.

look, appear; as *specimen*, *prospect*.

kind; as *species*.

breathe; as *aspire*.

standing; as *status*.

star; *constellation*.

draw tight, bind; as *stringent*.

build; as *construe*, *construct*.

follow; as *pursue*.

persuade; as *dissuade*, *persuasion*.

take; as *assume*, *presumption*.

rise; as *insurgent*, *insurrection*.

touch; as *contact*.

cut; as *tailor*.

touch; as *tangent*.

cover; as *tegument*, *detect*.

time; as *temporary*.

stretch, reach; as *contend*, *content*.

witness; as *attest*.

twist, wring; as *contort*.

draw; as *attract*.

<u>ROOT</u>	<u>MEANING AND EXAMPLE</u>
trit	rub; as <i>attrition</i> .
trud, trus	thrust; as <i>intrude</i> , <i>abstruse</i> .
un	one; as <i>unanimous</i> (anim = mind).
und	wave, flow; as <i>inundate</i> .
ut, util	use, useful; as <i>utensil</i> , <i>utilize</i> .
vad, vas	go; as <i>evade</i> .
val	be strong; as <i>valid</i> .
ven, vent	come; as <i>convene</i> , <i>convention</i> .
vert, vers	turn; as <i>pervert</i> , <i>version</i> .
vi, via	way, road; as <i>viaduct</i> (duct = lead, bring), <i>devious</i> .
vic	a change, turn; as <i>vicarious</i> .
vid, vis	see, appear; as <i>evident</i> , <i>visible</i> .
viv	live; as <i>vivacity</i> .
voc	call; as <i>vocation</i> .
volv, volu, volut	roll; as <i>circumvolve</i> , <i>voluble</i> , <i>revolution</i> .
vot	vow; as <i>votive</i> .

Prefixes and Suffixes

Following is a list of the principal *prefixes* and *suffixes* of Anglo-Saxon (old form of English), Latin, and Greek origin, now in use in the English language:

ENGLISH PREFIXES

Those used to form nouns:

fore	before; as <i>fore-father</i> .
mis	wrong; as <i>mis-deed</i> , <i>mis-chance</i> .
un	the opposite of; as <i>un-truth</i> , <i>un-belief</i>

Those used to form adjectives:

a	on; as <i>a-live</i> , <i>a-board</i> , <i>a-sleep</i> .
for	quite, thoroughly; as <i>for-lorn</i> .
un	not; as <i>un-true</i> , <i>un-wise</i> .
mis	wrong; as <i>mis-shapen</i> .

Those used to form verbs:

a	out, from, away, often used to intensify the meaning of the verb; as <i>a-rise</i> , <i>a-wake</i> , <i>a-rouse</i> .
be	by, and is used in several ways: 1. To intensify the meaning of the verb; as <i>be-daub</i>, <i>be-smear</i>. 2. To change intransitive verbs to transitive ones; as <i>be-speak</i>, <i>be-think</i>. 3. To form transitive verbs out of adjectives and nouns; as <i>be-friend</i>, <i>be-night</i>, <i>be-troth</i>.
for	through, thoroughly, used to intensify the meaning of the verb; as <i>for-bid</i> , <i>for-give</i> , <i>for-get</i> .
fore	before; as <i>fore-bode</i> , <i>fore-tell</i> .
mis	wrongly; as <i>mis-believe</i> , <i>mis-call</i> .

un	back; as <i>un-bind</i> , <i>un-do</i> .
with	back, against; as <i>with-draw</i> , <i>with-stand</i> .

Those used to form adverbs:

a	on; as <i>a-foot</i> , <i>a-field</i> .
be	on; as <i>be-fore</i> , <i>be-sides</i> .

LATIN PREFIXES

Latin prefixes frequently vary their forms in composition, the final letter being changed to harmonize in sound with the first syllable of the base. Thus, *ad* becomes *ac* in *accede*; *al* in *allude*; *at* in *attract*; and so on. This process is called assimilation of sound.

The following are the more commonly used prefixes of Latin origin:

a, ab, abs	from, away; as <i>a-vert</i> , <i>ab-jure</i> , <i>abs-ent</i> .
ad	to; as <i>ad-here</i> . By assimilation <i>ad</i> takes the forms <i>a</i> , <i>ac</i> , <i>af</i> , <i>al</i> , <i>an</i> , <i>ap</i> , <i>as</i> and <i>at</i> , as <i>a-spire</i> , <i>ac-cord</i> , <i>affect</i> , <i>al-lude</i> , <i>an-nex</i> , <i>ap-peal</i> , <i>as-sume</i> , <i>at-tract</i> .
amb, am (from <i>ambi</i>)	about; as <i>amb-ition</i> , <i>am-putate</i> .
ante or anti	before; as <i>ante-date</i> , <i>anti-cipate</i> .
bis, bi	twice; as <i>bi-sect</i> .
circum	around; as <i>circum-navigate</i> .
com, con	together; as <i>com-mand</i> , <i>con-vivial</i> . This prefix assumes the forms <i>col</i> and <i>cor</i> before <i>l</i> and <i>r</i> and <i>co</i> before a vowel; as <i>col-lect</i> , <i>cor-rect</i> , <i>com-mit</i> , <i>co-eval</i> , <i>co-worker</i> .
contra, contro, or counter	against; as <i>contra-dict</i> , <i>contra-vert</i> , <i>counter-act</i> .
de	down, from, about; as <i>de-scend</i> , <i>de-part</i> , <i>de-scribe</i> .
demi	half; as <i>demi-god</i> .

dis, di, dif	apart; in two, denoting difference or negation; as <i>dis-sent</i> , <i>di-vision</i> , <i>dif-ficulty</i> .
ex, e, or ef	out of, from; as <i>ex-alt</i> , <i>e-lect</i> , <i>ef-face</i> .
extra	out of, beyond; as <i>extra-ordinary</i> .
in	in, into; as <i>in-vade</i> . This prefix changes by assimilation into <i>il</i> , <i>im</i> , <i>ir</i> ; as <i>il-lustrate</i> , <i>im-merse</i> , <i>ir-ritate</i> . In its French form, <i>en</i> , it is found in <i>en-chant</i> , <i>en-dure</i> , etc.
in	not; by assimilation <i>il</i> , <i>im</i> , <i>ir</i> ; as <i>in-distinct</i> , <i>il-legal</i> , <i>im-piety</i> , <i>ir-revocable</i> .
inter, intro	between, within, among; as <i>inter-pose</i> , <i>intro-duce</i> , <i>enter-prise</i> .
male	ill; as <i>mal-treat</i> , <i>male-volent</i> .
non	not; as <i>non-sense</i> .
ob	in front of, against; by assimilation, <i>oc</i> , <i>of</i> , <i>op</i> ; as <i>ob-viate</i> , <i>oc-cupy</i> , <i>of-fend</i> , <i>op-pose</i> .
pene, pen	almost; as <i>pen-insula</i> .
per	through; by assimilation, <i>pel</i> and <i>pil</i> ; as <i>per-ceive</i> , <i>pel-lucid</i> , <i>pil-grim</i> .
post	after; as <i>post-pone</i> , <i>post-script</i> .
pre	before; as <i>pre-dict</i> , <i>pre-cede</i> .
preter	past, beyond; as <i>preter-ite</i> , <i>preter-natural</i> .
pro	forward, before; as <i>pro-ceed</i> , <i>pro-gress</i> . <i>Pro</i> is found in the forms <i>pur</i> and <i>por</i> in <i>pur-chase</i> , <i>pur-sue</i> , <i>por-tray</i> .
pro	instead of; as <i>pro-noun</i> .
re, red	back, again; as <i>re-cede</i> , <i>re-adopt</i> , <i>red-olent</i> .
retro	backwards; as <i>retro-grade</i> , <i>retro-spect</i> .
se, sed	apart, away; as <i>se-cede</i> , <i>sed-ition</i> .
semi	half; as <i>semi-circle</i> .
sine	without; as <i>sine-cure</i> .

sub	under, up from below; by assimilation, <i>suc</i> , <i>suf</i> , <i>sug</i> , <i>sum</i> , <i>sup</i> , <i>sur</i> , <i>sus</i> ; as <i>sub-ject</i> , <i>suc-cor</i> , <i>suf-fer</i> , <i>sug-gest</i> , <i>sum-mon</i> , <i>sup-press</i> , <i>sur-prise</i> , <i>sus-tain</i> .
subter	under; as <i>subter-fuge</i> .
super, sur	above, beyond; as <i>super-pose</i> , <i>super-natural</i> , <i>sur-name</i> .
trans	across; as <i>trans-form</i> .
ultra	beyond; as <i>ultra-liberal</i> .
un, uni	one; as <i>un-animous</i> , <i>uni-form</i> .
vice	instead of; as <i>vice-chancellor</i> , <i>vice-roy</i> .

GREEK PREFIXES

The following are the Greek prefixes in most common use:

a, an	not; as <i>an-archy</i> , <i>a-morphous</i> .
amphi	on both sides, round about; as <i>amphi-bious</i> , <i>amphi-theater</i> .
ana	up, back; as <i>ana-tomy</i> , <i>ana-lysis</i> .
anti	against, opposite to; as <i>anti-dote</i> , <i>ant-arctic</i> .
apo, ap	away from; as <i>apo-state</i> , <i>apo-stle</i> , <i>ap-helion</i> .
archi, arche, arch	first, chief; as <i>archi-tect</i> , <i>arche-type</i> , <i>arch-bishop</i> .
auto, auth	self; as <i>auto-crat</i> , <i>auto-nomy</i> , <i>auth-entic</i> .
cata, cat	down, over; as <i>cata-logue</i> , <i>cat-astrophe</i> .
dia	through, across; as <i>dia-meter</i> , <i>dia-gonal</i> .
dis, di	twice; as <i>dis-syllable</i> , <i>di-pthong</i> .
dys	ill; as <i>dys-peptic</i> .
ec, ex	out of; as <i>ec-centric</i> , <i>ex-odus</i> .
en, el, em	in, all, at; as <i>en-comium</i> , <i>el-lipse</i> , <i>em-phasis</i> .

epi	upon; as <i>epi-taph</i> , <i>epi-demic</i> .
eu, ev	well; as <i>eu-logy</i> , <i>ev-angelist</i> .
hemi	half; as <i>hemi-sphere</i> .
hyper	over, above; as <i>hyper-bole</i> , <i>hyper-critical</i> .
hypo	under; as <i>hypo-crite</i> .
meta, met	after, changed for; as <i>meta-phor</i> , <i>met-onymy</i> .
mono	alone; as <i>mono-gram</i> , <i>mono-poly</i> .
pan	all; as <i>pan-acea</i> , <i>pan-orama</i> .
para, par	beside, against; as <i>para-dox</i> , <i>par-enthesis</i> .
peri	around; as <i>peri-meter</i> , <i>peri-gee</i> , <i>peri-helion</i> .
poly	many; as <i>poly-gamy</i> , <i>poly-gon</i> , <i>poly-technic</i> .
pro	before; as <i>pro-phet</i> , <i>pro-logue</i> .
syn, syl, sym, sy	with; as <i>syn-tax</i> , <i>syl-lable</i> , <i>sym-pathy</i> , <i>sy-stem</i> .

ENGLISH SUFFIXES

The principal English suffixes are the following:

Those used to form abstract nouns:

dom	denoting judgment, authority, dominion; as <i>wis-dom</i> , <i>free-dom</i> , <i>king-dom</i> .
hood, head	denoting state, rank, character; as <i>man-hood</i> , <i>god-head</i> .
ing	denoting action, state; as <i>read-ing</i> , <i>hear-ing</i> .
ness	denoting state, quality; as <i>good-ness</i> , <i>great-ness</i> .
red	denoting mode, fashion; as <i>hat-red</i> , <i>kind-red</i> .
ship	denoting shape, manner, form; as <i>friend-ship</i> , <i>wor-ship</i> = <i>worth-ship</i> .

Those used to form diminutives:

en	as <i>maid-en</i> , <i>kitt-en</i> (from <i>cat</i>), <i>kitch-en</i> (from <i>cook</i>).
-----------	---

ie	as <i>bird-ie</i> , <i>dog-g-ie</i> , <i>Ann-ie</i> .
ing	as <i>farth-ing</i> (from <i>fourth</i>), <i>tith-ing</i> (from <i>tenth</i>).
kin	as <i>bump-kin</i> , <i>lamb-kin</i> , <i>nap-kin</i> .
ling	as <i>dar-ling</i> , <i>duck-ling</i> , <i>gos-ling</i> .
ock	as <i>bull-ock</i> , <i>hill-ock</i> .

Miscellaneous:

er, ar, or, ier, yer	denoting the agent or doer; as <i>paint-er</i> , <i>begg-ar</i> , <i>sail-or</i> , <i>cloth-ier</i> , <i>law-yer</i> .
ster	(formerly a feminine suffix) denoting a female agent; as <i>spin-ster</i> ; also an agent of either sex; as <i>huck-ster</i> , <i>poll-ster</i> . It is also used as a term of depreciation; as <i>game-ster</i> , <i>young-ster</i> .
ard, art	characterizing a person by a peculiarity; as <i>cow-ard</i> , <i>drunk-ard</i> , <i>brag-g-art</i> .
le, el	denoting an instrument; as <i>gird-le</i> , <i>hand-le</i> , <i>shov-el</i> .
ther	marking the agent and used in terms of relationship; as <i>fa-ther</i> , <i>daugh-ter</i> , <i>mo-ther</i> .
craft	denoting skill, a trade; as <i>book-craft</i> , <i>wood-craft</i> .
fare	denoting way, course; as <i>thorough-fare</i> , <i>wel-fare</i> .
ric	denoting power, dominion; as <i>bishop-ric</i> .
wright	a workman; as <i>wheel-wright</i> ; <i>play-wright</i> .
monger	a dealer; as <i>news-monger</i> .

Those used to form adjectives:

ed, d	the suffix of the past participle, is added to nouns to form adjectives; as <i>wing-ed</i> , <i>talent-ed</i> , <i>bright-eye-d</i> , <i>golden-hair-ed</i> .
en	made of; as <i>wood-en</i> , <i>gold-en</i> .
fast	fast, firm; as <i>stead-fast</i> , <i>shame-faced</i> = <i>shame-fast</i> , which is the old form of the word.

fold	denoting multiplication; as <i>two-fold</i> , <i>mani-fold</i> .
ful	full; as <i>hate-ful</i> , <i>will-ful</i> .
ing	the suffix of the present participle; as <i>pleas-ing</i> , <i>annoy-ing</i> .
ish	like, when added to nouns; as <i>boy-ish</i> , <i>girl-ish</i> ; when added to adjectives, the suffix means "somewhat," "rather"; as <i>black-ish</i> , <i>green-ish</i> .
less	loose from, without; as <i>fear-less</i> , <i>shame-less</i> . This suffix has no connection with the comparative of little.
like	like; as <i>child-like</i> , <i>war-like</i> .
ly	like; as <i>man-ly</i> , <i>sick-ly</i> . This suffix is a softened form of the preceding.
some	like, partaking of a certain quality; as <i>glad-some</i> , <i>loath-some</i> . This suffix is found in a corrupt form in <i>buxom</i> , <i>flotsam</i> , and <i>jetsam</i> .
teen, ty	ten; as in the numerals.
th	ordinal; as <i>fif-th</i> , <i>six-th</i> .
ward	becoming, leading to; as <i>south-ward</i> , <i>for-ward</i> .
wise	mode, way, manner; as <i>like-wise</i> , <i>other-wise</i> .
y, ey	of the nature of; as <i>ic-y</i> , <i>show-y</i> .

Those used to form verbs:

en	imparting the idea of cause, forms transitive verbs from nouns and adjectives; as <i>strength-en</i> , <i>black-en</i> , <i>fat-t-en</i> .
er, r	is added to adjectives and verbs, and imparts to the base word a frequentative and intensive force; as <i>hind-er</i> , <i>low-er</i> , <i>wand-er</i> (from <i>wend</i>), <i>glimm-er</i> (from <i>gleam</i>).

le, l	is added to nouns and verbs, and imparts to the base word the sense of frequency, or diminution; as <i>nest-le</i> , <i>thratt-le</i> (from <i>throat</i>), <i>start-le</i> , <i>stradd-le</i> (from <i>stride</i>).
k	frequentative; as <i>tal-k</i> (from <i>tell</i>), <i>har-k</i> (from <i>hear</i>).
se	to make, forms transitive verbs from adjectives; as <i>clean-se</i>

Those used to form adverbs:

es or s	the old suffix of the possessive case; as in <i>need-s</i> , <i>beside-s</i> , <i>thence</i> , <i>unawar-es</i> .
ere	denoting place in; as <i>here</i> (related to <i>he</i>), <i>th-ere</i> (related to <i>that</i>), <i>wh-ere</i> (related to <i>who</i>).
ly	a softened form of like; as <i>on-ly</i> , <i>utter-ly</i> , <i>wicked-ly</i> .
ling, long	denoting direction; as in <i>dark-ling</i> , <i>head-long</i> , <i>side-long</i> .
ther	denoting place to; as <i>hi-ther</i> , <i>thi-ther</i> , <i>whi-ther</i> .
ward, wards	denoting direction; as <i>home-ward</i> , <i>back-wards</i> .
wise	mode or manner; as <i>like-wise</i> , <i>other-wise</i> .
way, ways	In Old English, the accusative (objective case) of nouns was sometimes used with the force of an adverb. Hence the adverbs <i>al-ways</i> , <i>straight-way</i> . The general use of the possessive suffix <i>-es</i> or <i>-s</i> to form adverbs is accountable for the forms <i>al-ways</i> , <i>straight-ways</i> , <i>side-ways</i> .

LATIN SUFFIXES

The principal suffixes of Latin origin are the following:

Those used to form nouns:

1. Those forming abstract nouns:

age	act, condition, collection of; as <i>cour-age</i> , <i>hom-age</i> , <i>foli-age</i> .
anee, ancy, ence, or ency	state or quality of being; as <i>abund-ance</i> , <i>const-ancy</i> , <i>indulg-ence</i> , <i>consist-ency</i> .
ice	that which; as <i>just-ice</i> .
ment	state of being, that which; as <i>excite-ment</i> , <i>command-ment</i> . It is also used to denote instrument, as in <i>docu-ment</i> , <i>orna-ment</i> .
mony	state of, that which; as <i>acri-mony</i> , <i>resti-mony</i> .
ion	the act of, state of being; as <i>redempt-ion</i> , <i>evas-ion</i> , <i>act-ion</i> .
tude	denoting condition; as <i>forti-tude</i> , <i>grati-tude</i> .
ty	state or quality of; as <i>chari-ty</i> , <i>cruel-ty</i> .
ure or eur	state of, that which; as <i>grand-eur</i> , <i>creat-ure</i> .
y	denoting condition or faculty; as <i>miser-y</i> , <i>victor-y</i> .

2. Those denoting simply a person, or one who performs the action signified by the base.

ain or an	connected with; as <i>artis-an</i> , <i>chapl-ain</i> .
ant or ent	one who; as <i>assist-ant</i> , <i>stud-ent</i> .
ary, ier, eer, or er	one who; as <i>secret-ary</i> , <i>brigad-ier</i> , <i>engin-eer</i> , <i>marin-er</i> .
ate	one who; as <i>advoc-ate</i> , <i>cur-ate</i> . In the French form, <i>ee</i> or <i>e</i> , this suffix denotes the object of an action; as <i>legat-ee</i> , <i>nomi-n-ee</i> , <i>employ-ee</i> .

ist	one who practises or is devoted to; as <i>evangel-ist</i> , <i>theor-ist</i> .
or or er	one who; as <i>conspirat-or</i> , <i>success-or</i> , <i>doct-or</i> , <i>preach-er</i> .
trix	denoting a female agent; as <i>execu-trix</i> .

3. Those forming diminutives:

el or le	as <i>lib-el</i> (from <i>liber</i> , a book), <i>cast-le</i> (from <i>castrum</i> , a fort).
cle or cule	as <i>vesi-cle</i> , <i>animal-cule</i> .
ule	as <i>glob-ule</i> .
ette or let	as <i>ros-ette</i> , <i>stream-let</i> .

4. Those forming collective nouns:

ry	as <i>bandit-ry</i> .
-----------	-----------------------

Those used to form adjectives:

aceous or acious	made of, having the quality of; as <i>farin-aceous</i> , <i>cap-acious</i> .
al	belonging to; as <i>leg-al</i> , <i>reg-al</i> .
an, ane, or ain	connected with; as <i>hum-an</i> , <i>hum-ane</i> , <i>cert-ain</i> .
ar or er	belonging to; as <i>regul-ar</i> , <i>premi-er</i> .
ary, arious	relating or belonging to; as <i>station-ary</i> , <i>greg-arious</i> .
able or ible	that may be done; as <i>port-able</i> , <i>sens-ible</i> .
ant or ent	equivalent to the force of the present participle inflection -ing; as <i>discord-ant</i> , <i>cur-rent</i> .
escent	becoming; as <i>putr-escent</i> .
esque	partaking of; as <i>pictur-esque</i> .
ic	belonging to; as <i>civ-ic</i> , <i>rust-ic</i> .
id	having the quality of; as <i>acr-id</i> , <i>frig-id</i> .
ile, il, eel, or le	capable of being; as <i>doc-ile</i> , <i>civ-il</i> , <i>gent-eel</i> , <i>ab-le</i> .

ine	belonging to; as <i>can-ine</i> , <i>sal-ine</i> .
ive	inclined to; as <i>plaint-ive</i> , <i>abus-ive</i> .
ory	fitted or relating to; as <i>admonit-ory</i> .
ose or ous	full of; as <i>verb-ase</i> , <i>curi-ous</i> .

Those used to form verbs:

ate	to perform the act of, cause; as <i>navig-ate</i> .
fy	to make; as <i>beauti-fy</i> , <i>magni-fy</i> .
ish	to make; as <i>fin-ish</i> .

GREEK SUFFIXES

ic	belonging to; as <i>aromat-ic</i> , <i>graph-ic</i> .
st	agent; as <i>bapti-st</i> , <i>bolani-st</i> .
isk	a diminutive; as <i>aster-isk</i> , <i>obel-isk</i> .
y	making abstract nouns; as <i>philosoph-y</i> , <i>monarch-y</i> .
ize or ise	forming verbs; as <i>anglic-ize</i> , <i>critic-ise</i> .

THE HOT PREFIXES AND
ROOTS THAT DENOTE
THE SAME MEANING
OR FEELING

Here is a list of the most important prefixes and roots that impart a certain meaning or feeling. They can be instant clues to the meanings of more than 200,000 words.

Prefixes that mean *to*, *with*, *between*, or *among*

<u>PREFIX</u>	<u>MEANING</u>	<u>EXAMPLES</u>
ad, ac, af, an, ap, ap, as, at	to, toward	<i>adapt</i> —to fit into <i>adhere</i> —to stick to <i>attract</i> —to draw near
com, con, co, col	with, together	<i>combine</i> —to bring together <i>contact</i> —to touch together <i>collect</i> —to bring together <i>co-worker</i> —one who works together with another worker
in, il, ir, im	into	<i>inject</i> —to put into <i>impose</i> —to force into <i>illustrate</i> —to put into example <i>irritate</i> —to put into discomfort
inter	between, among	<i>international</i> —among nations <i>interact</i> —to act among the people
pro	forward, going ahead	<i>proceed</i> —to go forward <i>promote</i> —to move forward

Prefixes that mean *bad*

<u>PREFIX</u>	<u>MEANING</u>	<u>EXAMPLES</u>
mal	wrong, bad	<i>malady</i> —illness <i>malevolent</i> —bad <i>malfunction</i> —bad functioning
mis	wrong, badly	<i>mistreat</i> —to treat badly <i>mistake</i> —to get wrong

Prefixes that mean *away from*, *not*, or *against*

<u>PREFIX</u>	<u>MEANING</u>	<u>EXAMPLES</u>
ab	away from	<i>absent</i> —not to be present, away <i>abscond</i> —to run away
de, dis	away from, down, the opposite of, apart, not	<i>depart</i> —to go away from <i>decline</i> —to turn down <i>dislike</i> —not to like <i>dishonest</i> —not honest <i>distant</i> —apart
ex, e, ef	out, from	<i>exit</i> —to go out <i>eject</i> —to throw out <i>efface</i> —to rub out, erase
in, il, ir, im	not	<i>inactive</i> —not active <i>impossible</i> —not possible <i>ill-mannered</i> —not mannered <i>irreversible</i> —not reversible
non	not	<i>nonsense</i> —no sense <i>nonstop</i> —having no stops
un	not	<i>unhelpful</i> —not helpful <i>uninterested</i> —not interested
anti	against	<i>anti-freeze</i> —a substance used to prevent freezing <i>anti-social</i> —refers to someone who's not social
ob	against, in front of	<i>obstacle</i> —something that stands in the way of <i>obstinate</i> —inflexible

Prefixes that denote distance

<u>PREFIX</u>	<u>MEANING</u>	<u>EXAMPLES</u>
circum	around	<i>circumscribe</i> —to write or inscribe in a circle <i>circumspect</i> —to watch around or be very careful
equ, equi	equal, the same	<i>equalize</i> —to make equal <i>equitable</i> —fair, equal
post	after	<i>postpone</i> —to do after <i>postmortem</i> —after death
pre	before	<i>preview</i> —a viewing that goes before another viewing <i>prehistorical</i> —before written history
trans	across	<i>transcontinental</i> —across the continent <i>transit</i> —act of going across
re	back, again	<i>retell</i> —to tell again <i>recall</i> —to call back, to remember
sub	under	<i>subordinate</i> —under something else <i>subconscious</i> —under the conscious
super	over, above	<i>superimpose</i> —to put something over something else <i>superstar</i> —a star greater than other stars
un, uni	one	<i>unity</i> —oneness <i>unanimous</i> —sharing one view <i>unidirectional</i> —having one direction

Roots

<u>PREFIX</u>	<u>MEANING</u>	<u>EXAMPLES</u>
cap, capt, cept, ceive	to take, to hold	<i>captive</i> —one who is held <i>receive</i> —to take <i>capable</i> —to be able to take hold of things <i>concept</i> —an idea or thought held in mind
cred	to believe	<i>credible</i> —believable <i>credit</i> —belief, trust
curr, curs, cours	to run	<i>current</i> —now in progress, running <i>cursor</i> —a moveable indicator <i>recourse</i> —to run for aid
dic, dict	to say	<i>indicate</i> —to say by demonstrating <i>diction</i> —verbal saying
duc, duct	to lead	<i>induce</i> —to lead to action <i>aqueduct</i> —a pipe or waterway that leads water somewhere
fac, fic, fect, fy	to make, to do	<i>facile</i> —easy to do <i>fiction</i> —something that has been made up <i>satisfy</i> —to make happy <i>affect</i> —to make a change in
jec, ject	to throw	<i>project</i> —to put forward <i>trajectory</i> —a path of an object that has been thrown
mit, mis	to send	<i>admit</i> —to send in <i>missile</i> —something that gets sent through the air

<u>PREFIX</u>	<u>MEANING</u>	<u>EXAMPLES</u>
pon, pos	to place	<i>transpose</i> —to place across <i>compose</i> —to put into place many parts <i>deposit</i> —to place in something
scrib, script	to write	<i>describe</i> —to write or tell about <i>scripture</i> —a written tablet
spec, spic	to look	<i>specimen</i> —an example to look at <i>inspect</i> —to look over
ten, tain	to hold	<i>maintain</i> —to hold up or keep <i>retentive</i> —holding
ven, vent	to come	<i>advent</i> —a coming <i>convene</i> —to come together

THREE VOCABULARY STRATEGIES

Introduction

Although **antonyms** (opposites of words) are not on the SAT, it is still important for you to know vocabulary and the strategies to figure out the meanings of words, since there are many questions involving difficult words in all the sections on the Verbal part of the SAT, that is, the **Sentence Completions and Critical Reading Parts**.



USE ROOTS, PREFIXES, AND SUFFIXES TO GET THE MEANINGS OF WORDS

You can increase your vocabulary tremendously by learning Latin and Greek roots, prefixes, and suffixes. Sixty percent of all the words in our English language are derived from Latin and Greek. By learning certain Latin and Greek roots, prefixes, and suffixes, you will be able to understand the meanings of more than 200,000 additional English words. See *Developing Your Vocabulary Through Prefixes, Roots, and Suffixes That Can Give You the Meaning of over 200,000 Words* on page 25, and *The Hot Prefixes and Roots That Denote the Same Meaning or Feeling* on page 45.

EXAMPLE 1

Opposite of PROFICIENT:

- (A) antiseptic
- (B) unwilling
- (C) inconsiderate
- (D) neglectful
- (E) awkward

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice E is correct. The prefix PRO means *forward, for the purpose of*. The root FIC means *to make or to do*. Therefore, PROFICIENT literally means *doing something in a forward way*. The definition of *proficient* is *skillful, adept, capable*. The antonym of *proficient* is, accordingly, *awkward, incapable*.

EXAMPLE 2

Opposite of DELUDE:

- (A) include
- (B) guide
- (C) reply
- (D) upgrade
- (E) welcome

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice B is correct. The prefix DE means *downward, against*. The root LUD means *to play* (a game). Therefore, DELUDE literally means *to play a game against*. The definition of *delude* is *to deceive, to mislead*. The antonym of *delude* is accordingly *to guide*.

EXAMPLE 3

Opposite of LAUDATORY:

- (A) vacating
- (B) satisfactory
- (C) revoking
- (D) faultfinding
- (E) silent

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice D is correct. The root LAUD means *praise*. The suffix ORY means *a tendency toward*. Therefore, LAUDATORY means having *a tendency toward praising someone*. The definition of *laudatory* is *praising*. The antonym of *laudatory* is, accordingly, *faultfinding*.

EXAMPLE 4

Opposite of SUBSTANTIATE:

- (A) reveal
- (B) intimidate
- (C) disprove
- (D) integrate
- (E) assist

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice C is correct. The prefix SUB means *under*. The root STA means *to stand*. The suffix ATE is a verb form indicating *the act of*. Therefore, SUBSTANTIATE literally means *to perform the act of standing under*. The definition of *substantiate* is *to support* with proof or evidence. The antonym is, accordingly, *disprove*.

EXAMPLE 5

Opposite of TENACIOUS:

- (A) changing
- (B) stupid
- (C) unconscious
- (D) poor
- (E) antagonistic

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice A is correct.

TEN = to hold; TENACIOUS = holding—OPPOSITE = *changing*

EXAMPLE 6

Opposite of RECEDE:

- (A) accede
- (B) settle
- (C) surrender
- (D) advance
- (E) reform

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice D is correct.

RE = back; CED = to go; RECEDE = to go back—OPPOSITE = *advance*

EXAMPLE 7

Opposite of CIRCUMSPECT:

- (A) suspicious
- (B) overbearing
- (C) listless
- (D) determined
- (E) careless

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice E is correct.

CIRCUM = around; SPECT = to look or see; CIRCUMSPECT = to look all around or make sure that you see everything, careful—OPPOSITE = *careless*

EXAMPLE 8

Opposite of MALEDICTION:

- (A) sloppiness
- (B) praise
- (C) health
- (D) religiousness
- (E) proof

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice B is correct.

MAL = bad; DICT = to speak; MALEDICTION = to speak badly about—OPPOSITE = *praise*

EXAMPLE 9

Opposite of PRECURSORY:

- (A) succeeding
- (B) flamboyant
- (C) cautious
- (D) simple
- (E) cheap

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice A is correct.

PRE = before; CURS = to run; PRECURSORY = run before—OPPOSITE = *succeeding*

EXAMPLE 10

Opposite of CIRCUMVENT:

- (A) to go the straight route
- (B) alleviate
- (C) to prey on one's emotions
- (D) scintillate
- (E) perceive correctly

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice A is correct.

CIRCUM = around (like a circle); VENT = to come; CIRCUMVENT = to come around—OPPOSITE = *to go the straight route*



PAY ATTENTION TO THE SOUND OR FEELING OF THE WORD—WHETHER POSITIVE OR NEGATIVE, HARSH OR MILD, BIG OR LITTLE, ETC.

If the word sounds harsh or terrible, such as “obstreperous,” the meaning probably is something harsh or terrible. If you’re looking for a word opposite in meaning to “obstreperous,” look for a word or words that have a softer sound, such as “pleasantly quiet or docile.” The sense of “obstreperous” can also seem to be negative—so if you’re looking for a synonym, look for a negative word. If you’re looking for an opposite (antonym), look for a positive word.

EXAMPLE 1

Opposite of BELLIGERENCY:

- (A) pain
- (B) silence
- (C) homeliness
- (D) elegance
- (E) peace

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice E is correct. The word BELLIGERENCY imparts a tone of forcefulness or confusion and means warlike. The opposite would be calmness or peacefulness. The closest choices are choice B or E, with E a little closer to the opposite in tone for the capitalized word. Of course, if you knew the root BELLI means “war,” you could see the opposite as (E) peace.

EXAMPLE 2

Opposite of DEGRADE:

- (A) startle
- (B) elevate
- (C) encircle
- (D) replace
- (E) assemble

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice B is correct. Here you can think of the DE in DEGRADE as a prefix that is negative (bad) and means *down*, and in fact DEGRADE does mean to debase or lower. So you should look for an opposite that would be a word with a *positive* (good) meaning. The best word from the choices is (B) elevate.

EXAMPLE 3

Opposite of OBFUSCATION:

- (A) illumination
- (B) irritation
- (C) conviction
- (D) minor offense
- (E) stable environment

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice A is correct. The prefix OB is usually negative, as in obstacle or obliterate, and in fact OBFUSCATE means *darken* or *obscure*. So since we are looking for an opposite, you would look for a *positive* word. Choices A and E are positive, and you should go for the more positive of the two, which is Choice A.

EXAMPLE 4

Opposite of MUNIFICENCE:

- (A) disloyalty
- (B) stinginess
- (C) dispersion
- (D) simplicity
- (E) vehemence

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice B is correct because MUNIFICENCE means *generosity*. Many of the words ending in ENCE, like OPULENCE, EFFERVESCENCE, LUMINESCENCE, QUINTESSENCE, etc., represent or describe something big or bright. So the opposite of one of these words would denote something small or dark.

You can associate the prefix MUNI with money, as in “municipal bonds,” so the word MUNIFICENCE must deal with money and in a big way. The opposite deals with money in a small way. Choice B fits the bill.

EXAMPLE 5

Opposite of DETRIMENT:

- (A) recurrence
- (B) disclosure
- (C) resemblance
- (D) enhancement
- (E) postponement

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice D is correct. The prefix DE can also mean *against* and is negative, and DETRIMENT means something that causes damage or loss. So you should look for a positive word. The only one is (D) enhancement.

EXAMPLE 6

Opposite of UNDERSTATE:

- (A) embroider
- (B) initiate
- (C) distort
- (D) pacify
- (E) reiterate

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice A is correct. UNDERSTATE means something said in a restrained or downplayed manner. You see “under” in UNDERSTATE so look for a choice that gives you the impression of something that is “over” as in “overstated.” The only choice is (A) embroider, which means *to embellish*.

EXAMPLE 7

Opposite of DISHEARTEN:

- (A) engage
- (B) encourage
- (C) predict
- (D) dismember
- (E) misinform

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice B is correct. You see “heart” in DISHEARTEN. The DIS is negative or means “not to,” or “not to have heart,” and dishearten does mean *to discourage*. So you want to look for a *positive* word. Choice (B) encourage fits the bill.

EXAMPLE 8

Opposite of FIREBRAND:

- (A) an intellect
- (B) one who is charitable
- (C) one who makes peace
- (D) a philanthropist
- (E) one who is dishonest

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice C is correct. You see fire in FIREBRAND. So think of something fiery or dangerous. The opposite of FIREBRAND must be something that's calm or safe. The best choice is Choice C, whereas a FIREBRAND is someone who causes trouble.



**USE WORD ASSOCIATIONS TO DETERMINE WORD
MEANINGS AND THEIR OPPOSITES**

Looking at the root or part of any capitalized word may suggest an association with another word that looks similar and whose meaning you know. This new word's meaning may give you a clue as to the meaning of the original word or the opposite in meaning to the original word if you need an opposite. For example, *extricate* reminds us of the word "extract," the opposite of which is "to put together."

EXAMPLE 1

Opposite of STASIS:

- (A) stoppage
- (B) reduction
- (C) depletion
- (D) fluctuation
- (E) completion

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice D is correct. Think of STATIC or STATIONARY. The opposite would be moving or fluctuating since STASIS means stopping or retarding movement.

EXAMPLE 2

Opposite of APPEASE:

- (A) criticize
- (B) analyze
- (C) correct
- (D) incense
- (E) develop

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice D is correct. Appease means to placate. Think of PEACE in APPEASE. The opposite would be violent or incense.

EXAMPLE 3

Opposite of COMMISERATION:

- (A) undeserved reward
- (B) lack of sympathy
- (C) unexpected success
- (D) absence of talent
- (E) inexplicable danger

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice B is correct. Think of MISERY in the word COMMISERATION. Commiseration means the sharing of misery. Choice B is the only appropriate choice.

EXAMPLE 4

Opposite of JOCULAR:

- (A) unintentional
- (B) exotic
- (C) muscular
- (D) exaggerated
- (E) serious

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice E is correct. Think of JOKE in the word JOCULAR, which means given to joking. The opposite would be serious.

EXAMPLE 5

Opposite of ELONGATE:

- (A) melt
- (B) wind
- (C) confuse
- (D) smooth
- (E) shorten

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice E is correct. Think of the word LONG in ELONGATE, which means to lengthen. The opposite would be short or shorten.

EXAMPLE 6

Opposite of SLOTHFUL:

- (A) permanent
- (B) ambitious
- (C) average
- (D) truthful
- (E) plentiful

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice B is correct. Think of SLOTH, a very, very slow animal. So SLOTHFUL, which means lazy or sluggish, must be slow and unambitious. The opposite would be ambitious.

EXAMPLE 7

Opposite of FORTITUDE:

- (A) timidity
- (B) conservatism
- (C) placidity
- (D) laxness
- (E) ambition

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice A is correct. FORTITUDE means strength in the face of adversity; you should think of FORT or FORTIFY as something strong. The opposite would be weakness or *timidity*.

EXAMPLE 8

Opposite of LUCID:

- (A) underlying
- (B) abstruse
- (C) luxurious
- (D) tight
- (E) general

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice B is correct. LUCID means easily understood or clear; you should think of LUCITE, a clear plastic. The opposite of clear is hard to see through or abstruse. *Note:* The “ab” in “abstruse” makes Choice B the only *negative* choice, which is the opposite of the positive word LUCID.

EXAMPLE 9

Opposite of POTENT:

- (A) imposing
- (B) pertinent
- (C) feeble
- (D) comparable
- (E) frantic

EXPLANATORY ANSWER

Choice C is correct. Think of the word POTENTIAL or POWERFUL. To have potential is to have the ability or power to be able to do something. So the opposite would be feeble. You could also have thought of POTENT as a *positive* word. The opposite would be a negative word. The only two choices that are negative are choices C and E.

THE MOST FREQUENT
POSITIVE-NEGATIVE
SAT WORDS—
WORDS THAT HAVE
THE SAME MEANING;
PRACTICE QUESTIONS
WITH ANSWERS

Following is a list of popular SAT words and their opposites. *Note:* These words fit into specific categories, and it may be a little easier memorizing the meaning of these important words knowing what category they fit into.

<u>POSITIVE</u>	<u>NEGATIVE</u>
TO PRAISE	TO BELITTLE
acclaim	admonish
applaud	assail
commend	berate
eulogize	calumniate
exalt	castigate
extol	censure
flatter	chastise
hail	chide
laud	decry
panegyryze	denigrate
resound	denounce
tout	disparage
	excoriate
	execrate
	flay
	lambaste
	malign
	reprimand
	reproach
	scold
	upbraid
	vilify

POSITIVETO CALM OR MAKE
BETTER

abate

accede

accommodate

allay

ameliorate

appease

assuage

comply

concede

conciliate

gratify

mitigate

mollify

pacify

palliate

placate

propitiate

quell

satisfy

NEGATIVETO MAKE WORSE
OR RUFFLE

alienate

antagonize

contradict

dispute

fend off

embitter

estrangle

incense

infuriate

nettle

oppose

oppose

rebuff

repel

repulse

snub

POSITIVE

PLEASANT

affable
 amiable
 agreeable
 captivating
 congenial
 cordial
 courteous
 decorous
 engaging
 gracious
 obliging
 sportive
 unblemished
 undefiled

NEGATIVE

UNPLEASANT

callous
 cantankerous
 captious
 churlish
 contentious
 gruff
 irascible
 ireful
 obstinate
 ornery
 peevish
 perverse
 petulant
 querulous
 testy
 vexing
 wayward

POSITIVE

GENEROUS

altruistic

beneficent

benevolent

charitable

effusive

hospitable

humanitarian

magnanimous

munificent

philanthropic

NEGATIVE

CHEAP

frugal

miserly

niggardly

paltry

parsimonious

penurious

provident

skinflinty

spartan

tight-fisted

thrifty

POSITIVENEGATIVEABUNDANT OR
RICHSCARCE OR
POOR

affluent

dearth

bounteous

deficit

copious

destitute

luxuriant

exiguous

multifarious

impecunious

multitudinous

impoverished

myriad

indigent

opulent

insolvent

pecunious

meager

plenteous

paltry

plentiful

paucity

plethoric

penurious

profuse

scanty

prosperous

scarcity

superabundant

sparse

teeming

wealthy

POSITIVE

YIELDING

accommodating
amenable
compliant
deferential
docile
flexible
hospitable
inclined
malleable
obliging
pliant
submissive
subservient
tractable

NEGATIVE

NOT YIELDING

adamant
determinate
immutable
indomitable
inflexible
intractable
intransigent
recalcitrant
relentless
resolute
steadfast
tenacious

POSITIVENEGATIVE

COURAGEOUS

TIMID

audacious

diffident

dauntless

indisposed

gallant

laconic

intrepid

reserved

stalwart

reticent

undaunted

subdued

valiant

timorous

valorous

LIVELY

BLEAK

brisk

dejected

dynamic

forlorn

ebullient

lackluster

exhilaration

lugubrious

exuberant

melancholy

inspiring

muted

provocative

prostrate

scintillating

somber

stimulating

tenebrous

titillating

POSITIVE

CAREFUL

chary

circumspect

conscientious

discreet

exacting

fastidious

gingerly

heedful

judicious

meticulous

provident

prudent

punctilious

scrupulous

scrutiny

wary

NEGATIVE

CARELESS

culpable

felonious

indifferent

insouciant

lackadaisical

lax

negligent

perfunctory

rash

remiss

reprehensible

temerarious

<u>POSITIVE</u>	<u>NEGATIVE</u>
HUMBLE	HAUGHTY
demure	affected
diffident	aristocratic
indisposed	arrogant
introverted	audacious
laconic	authoritarian
plebian	autocratic
reluctant	condescending
restrained	disdainful
reticent	egotistical
subdued	flagrant
subservient	flippant
taciturn	imperious
timid	impertinent
timorous	impudent
unassuming	insolent
unostentatious	ostentatious
unpretentious	pompous
	proud
	supercilious
	vainglorious

Note: In many cases you can put a prefix “im” or “un” in front of the word and change its meaning to an opposite.

Example: Pecunious. Opposite: Impecunious
 Ostentatious. Opposite: Unostentatious

A LIST OF WORDS
APPEARING MORE THAN
ONCE ON THE SAT

We have made a computerized analysis of frequently occurring words on 47 complete SAT exams. (1,175 questions have been examined.) Following is a list of 167 SAT words or associated words appearing *more than once* on these 47 actual SAT exams.

The definitions of these words have not been included here because we want you to *refer to a dictionary* to learn the meanings of these words, which have been repeated in subsequent SAT question sections.

Note that after each word a numeral indicates the number of times that the word has appeared on the 47 actual SAT exams.

Also note that certain pairs of words have a left-side bracket. The bracket indicates that the words are very closely allied in meaning—so if you learn the meaning of one of the two words in the pair, you will easily arrive at the meaning of the other word of the pair.

Learn the meanings of these words, as they have a tendency to be repeated in questions of the SAT.

abolish 2	[coalesce 2	[distend 1
abridge 2	[coalescence 1	[distention 1
abstemious 2	[cohere 1	drawback 2
[accent 1	[coherent 1	efface 3
[accented 1	[compress 1	[effervesce 1
accolade 2	[compression 1	[effervescent 1
acquiesce 2	[confide 1	enhance 2
affirmation 2	[confidential 1	enigmatic 2
amass 2	confound 2	ephemeral 3
[ambivalence 1	congeal 2	equilibrium 3
[ambivalent 1	[contaminant 1	[euphonious 1
ambulatory 2	[contaminate 2	[euphony 1
ameliorate 2	converge 2	evacuate 2
amity 2	convivial 2	evanescent 2
anchor 2	copious 2	[expedite 1
antediluvian 2	corroborate 2	[expeditious 1
ascendancy 2	corrugated 2	[expendable 1
atrophy 2	[corrupt 1	[expenditures 1
[bane 1	[corruption 1	exclude 2
[baneful 1	cursor 2	facilitate 2
bizarre 2	[daunt 3	fallow 2
blunder 2	[dauntless 1	fertile 2
bungle 2	debilitate 2	[flourish 3
burgeon 2	deplete 2	[flower 1
[capitulate 1	discrepancy 3	fraudulent 3
[capitulation 1	disentangle 2	[fruitful 1
capricious 4	[disputatious 1	[fruitless 1
clemency 2	[dispute 2 ⁶⁰	garner 2

guile 2	parsimony 2	somber 4
hackneyed 2	paucity 2	[specify 1
hefty 2	penury 2	[specificity 1
hideous 2	[peripheral 2	spurn 2
hilarity 2	[periphery 2	squander 2
humane 2	placate 2	stymie 2
[hypocrisy 1	[precise 1	subtle 2
[hypocritical 1	[precision 1	summary 2
innocuous 2	premature 2	summon 3
irascible 2	premeditated 2	sumptuous 2
jettison 2	prevalent 2	[surreptitious 1
kindle 2	proclivity 2	[surreptitiously 1
[leniency 1	[prodigal 1	tantamount 2
[lenient 1	[prodigious 2	[tenacious 1
levity 1	[profuse 1	[tenacity 1
levitate 1	[profusion 2	[transience 1
listless 2	[pulverize 1	[transient 1
maladroit 2	[pulverized 1	turbulence 3
mitigate 2	rant 2	venturesome 3
mobile 2	recalcitrant 2	viable 2
munificent 2	recant 2	[vibrancy 1
munificence 1	replete 2	[vibrant 1
myriad 2	rescind 2	vilification 2
nefarious 2	reserve 2	[virulence 1
[obscure 1	ruffle 2	[virulent 1
[obscurity 1	rupture 2	whet 2
[opaque 1	saccharine 2	zany 2
[opacity 1	salubrious 2	

WORDS COMMONLY CONFUSED

aggravate/irritate	—to make worse —to annoy
allusion/illusion	—reference —error in vision
arbiter/arbitrary	—a supposedly unprejudiced judge —prejudiced
ascent/assent	—upward movement —agreement; to agree
ascetic/aesthetic	—self-denying —pertaining to the beautiful
averse/adverse	—disciplined —opposed
ban/bane	—prohibit —woe
canvas/canvass	—coarse cloth —examine; solicit
capital/capitol	—excellent; chief town; money; punishable by death or life imprisonment —state house
censure/censor	—find fault —purge or remove offensive passages

complacent/complaisant	—self-satisfied; smug —kindly; submissive
complement/compliment	—that which completes —praise
consul/council/counsel	—diplomatic representative —group of advisors —advice
contemptible/contemptuous	—despicable —scornful
continual/continuous	—occurring in steady, but not unbroken, order —occurring without interruption
cosmopolitan/metropolitan	—sophisticated —pertaining to the city
credible/creditable	—believable —worthy of praise
demure/demur	—pretending modesty —hesitate; raise objection
deprecate/depreciate	—disapprove regretfully —undervalue
discreet/discrete	—judicious; prudent —separate

disinterested/uninterested	—unprejudiced —not interested
divers/diverse	—several —varied
elicit/illicit	—extract —unlawful
emend/amend	—correct a text or manuscript —improve by making slight changes
eminent/imminent	—high in rank —threatening; at hand
equable/equitable	—even-tempered —just
exult/exalt	—rejoice —raise; praise highly
formally/formerly	—in a formal manner —at a previous time
gourmet/gourmand	—lover of good food —glutton
gorilla/guerrilla	—large ape —mercenary
hail/hale	—frozen pellets; to call; originate —strong, healthy

healthy/healthful	—possessing health —bringing about health
imply/infer	—indicate or suggest —draw a conclusion from
incredible/incredulous	—unbelievable —unbelieving
indigent/indigenous	—poor —native
ingenious/ingenuous	—skillful; clever; resourceful —frank; naïve
internment/interment	—imprisonment —burial
maize/maze	—corn —confusing network
martial/marital	—warlike —pertaining to marriage
mendacious/meritorious	—lying —possessing merit; praiseworthy
personal/personable	—private —attractive
perspicacious/perspicuous	—shrewd; acute —clear; lucid

practical/practicable	—sensible; useful —timely; capable of being accomplished
prodigal/prodigious	—wastefully lavish —extraordinarily large
prophecy/prophesy	—prediction —to predict
provided/providing	—on condition that —furnishing; giving
regal/regale	—royal —entertain lavishly
respectfully/respectively	—with respect —in the order already suggested
sanction/sanctity	—authorize —holiness
social/sociable	—pertaining to human society —companionable; friendly
statue/stature	—piece of sculpture —height
urban/urbane	—pertaining to the city —polished; suave
venal/venial	—corrupt, mercenary —pardonable